1. Determine the quality points of all courses taken
2. Add the total quality points and the total number of corresponding credit hours.
3. Divide the total quality points by the total credit hours.

Grading System

Numeric grades are used to represent student performance in a course. The letter grades are calculated according to the scheme outlined below. The minimum passing letter grade is D.

Numeral Grade	Letter Grade	Grade Value	Description
≥ 95	A+	4	Distinguished
≥ 90 and < 95	A	3.85	Excellent
≥ 85 and < 90	B+	3.75	Very Good
≥ 80 and < 85	B	3.40	Good
≥ 77 and < 80	C+	3.00	Fair
≥ 73 and < 77	C	2.70	Average
≥ 70 and < 73	C-	2.35	Satisfactory
≥ 65 and < 70	D+	1.85	Minimal Pass
≥ 60 and < 65	D	1.25	Weak
< 60	F	Zero	Fail
Other grade designations			
I	Incomplete		
P	Passing grade		
PH	Pass with Honor		
W	Withdrawal		
WE	Excused withdrawal		
CIP	Course in progress		
CR	Credit Granted		

Honors and Distinction

Semester Honor's Lists

At the end of each semester, the University recognizes students with distinguished academic achievements by enlisting their names on the Dean's Honor List and President's Honor List. To be eligible for a mention on the honor list, a student must satisfy the following ***general honor conditions***:

1. Is a full-time student

2. Has no “F” grade in any course
3. Does not have any incomplete grades
4. Has not been subject to any disciplinary action

Students whose semester GPA (SGPA) is 85 or above shall be placed on the Dean’s Honor List and receive a commendation from the College Dean. Students whose semester GPA is 90 or above are placed on the President’s Honor List and shall receive a commendation from the University President.

Graduating with Distinction

Students graduating with a cumulative GPA (CGPA) of 85 or above shall receive the designation “Distinction,” and those graduating with a CGPA of 90 or above shall receive the designation “High Distinction,” provided they satisfy the general honor conditions stated above. The designation shall be conferred on the students’ graduation certificates and official University transcripts.

Nazik Rafik Hariri Graduate Study Award

The two students among the graduating class with the highest GPA in the College of Business Administration and the College of Engineering shall receive the Nazik Rafik Hariri Graduate Study Award. The award is a full-tuition scholarship to pursue a master’s degree at RHU.

Withdrawal

Withdrawal from Courses

With the academic advisor's approval, a student may drop one or more courses during the drop/add period listed in the academic calendar. No record of the dropped course(s) shall appear on the student’s record.

A student, upon approval of the academic advisor, may withdraw from one or more courses between the second and the tenth week of classes of a regular semester or between the second and the sixth week of a summer semester, provided that the student’s load (excluding summer) does not fall below 12 credits. A grade of “W” shall be recorded on the student’s transcript for each withdrawn course, and the course shall be counted as a course attempt for purposes of the course repeat policy. Approval from the college dean is required if the withdrawal results in a load of less than 12 credits.

Students who withdraw from classes after the drop period are responsible for all related tuition and applicable fees.

Withdrawal from a Semester

Formal Withdrawal. In verifiably difficult circumstances, a student may petition to withdraw from all courses for the semester at any time after the drop/add period and before the final exams begin. After consulting with the concerned department

chairperson, the student's academic advisor, and the instructors of the courses, the College Dean may approve the petition if the reasons for withdrawal are legitimate. A grade of "WE" shall appear on the transcripts for each withdrawn course and shall not be counted as a course attempt in applying the course repeat policy. A student returning the following semester may register by following the routine registration procedures.

Informal Withdrawal. Suppose a student withdraws from the semester without following proper withdrawal procedures as described above. In that case, a grade of "F" shall be recorded on the student's transcripts for each registered course, and the course shall be counted as a course attempt in applying the course repeat policy.

If a student withdraws informally and later decides to return, approval from the relevant college is required. The college may approve the petition if convincing evidence is presented that the reasons for the withdrawal were beyond the student's control. If the college approves the request, the "F" grades recorded on the transcripts shall be replaced with a "WE." A "WE" grade is not considered when calculating the student's GPA, and the affected courses shall not be counted as course attempts for purposes of the course repeat policy.

A withdrawn student may only transfer credits for courses s/he has studied at another institution during that period if prior approval from the concerned college is obtained.

Withdrawal from the University

Students who wish to withdraw from the University are required to complete established clearance procedures.

Leave of Absence

During the first week of a semester, a student may petition for a leave of absence (LOA) for one or two consecutive semesters by submitting the Continuous Enrollment Registration Form to the Dean for approval and paying the USD 20 LOA fee for each semester on leave.

Students may accrue up to 3 semesters of LOA while pursuing a degree. The LOA semesters shall count toward decisions regarding the maximum number of semesters of allowed study deferment. A student returning immediately after the approved LOA period may register by following the routine registration procedures.

Suppose exigent circumstances prevent a student from returning immediately after an approved LOA period ends, and the student decides to reenroll in the University later. In that case, the student must seek approval for reinstatement from the college concerned. Re-enrolled students must follow the study plan and the catalog in effect at the time of re-enrollment.

A student on an approved LOA may transfer credits only for courses s/he studies at other institutions if prior approval to study those courses is obtained from the college concerned.

Special Enrollment

The Special Enrollment (SE) status applies to a student who has completed course requirements but needs to remain an active RHU student for a legitimate reason. A student who does not register as a special enrollment student for one or more regular semesters should apply for readmission to the program of interest. Refer to the Informal Withdrawal policy in this catalog.

To register under the SE status, the student should:

- Complete the Continuous Enrollment Registration Form stating the pertinent reasons and submit it to the Registrar's Office before the end of the Drop and Add Period. The academic advisor, the department chairperson, and the college dean must approve the form.
- Pay a Continuous Enrollment Fee of 20 USD at the RHU Finance Office for each semester under this status. A penalty of 10 USD shall be added if the fees are not paid during a regular payment period.

Non-Degree Students

A student who is not on track to earn a specific degree at RHU but wishes to register for courses they are eligible to take may do so as a non-degree student.

Further Studies

RHU offers students the opportunity to extend their knowledge by studying more than one major or earning more than one degree. Available options are:

1. Study a double major concurrently;
2. Earn two degrees simultaneously;
3. Return to the University after graduation for a second degree

Double Major

Students may concurrently study two majors within the same college that share similar degree structures. A student may apply for permission to study a second major if s/he is in good academic standing after completing at least 24 credits of coursework in the first major. Permission is granted if the student meets the admission requirements for the second major. Students must complete a minimum of 24 credits of core courses in the second major, in addition to the requirements of the first major, including all mandatory core courses of the second major. Upon graduation, a single diploma specifying both majors is awarded, provided that all requirements for each major have been completed. Credits for common courses are given to both majors.

Dual Degrees

Students may simultaneously pursue two different degrees from programs offered by other colleges, each with a different degree structure. Students may apply for permission to pursue a second degree if they are in good academic standing and have completed at least 24 credits of coursework in their first-degree major. The application is approved if the student meets the admission requirements for a second-degree major. Upon graduation, a diploma is granted for each degree major, provided that all the requirements of the respective degrees are completed, including the co-op experience. Credits for common courses are granted to both degrees, and the higher tuition rates for the two degrees shall be applied.

Second Degree

Students who have earned a degree and opt to return to the University at a later date to pursue a second degree may do so under the following conditions: (1) the admission requirements of the new degree are met; (2) the applicant may be required to repeat courses if they were taken more than three years ago or if the acquired grade is low as recommended by the department of the second degree.

Minors

Students can pursue a minor in an area different from their major under the following conditions:

- Obtain a Minor Cumulative Grade Point Average of no less than 70%
- Overlapping courses between student major requirements and minor requirements are counted to fulfill minor requirements
- A student may pursue up to two minors
- A maximum of nine credits can be counted towards the requirements of two minors

For further details, please refer to the specific college section.

Allowable Study Deferment Period

The permissible period of study deferment for a bachelor student, intentional or otherwise, shall be at most six semesters (summer excluded). If the six-semester limit is surpassed, the student shall be dismissed from the University. If the student decides to return later, s/he needs to apply for reinstatement, subject to approval by the relevant college. Reinstated students must follow the study plan and the catalog in effect at the time of reinstatement.

Change of Major

A student who has completed at least one semester of coursework in a major may request a major change at any time before the thirteenth week of a regular semester (fall or spring). The dean of the college (if in case of college change), in consultation with the department chairperson of the aspired program, decides on the request before the start of the following semester based on the following conditions: the request meets college admission requirements; a seat in the desired major is available; the student has not changed major before; the number of earned credits in the old major is less than 64 credits unless the student was forced out of the major for academic reasons. All required earned credits for the new major will be transferred and used to calculate the CGPA.

Usually, all earned credits required in the new major will be transferred and used to calculate the CGPA. However, if the student wishes, six credits may be deducted from the CGPA if the transfer is within the same college, or a maximum of twelve credits if the transfer is to a new college.

Intensive English Program students in IELP 095/100 Levels may request a major reassignment before completing 15 credit hours. Reassignment of major shall not be considered a transfer or a change of major.

Academic Complications

RHU is deeply committed to providing students with every opportunity to thrive, as their future success is our top priority. To ensure you can make the most of these opportunities, we encourage you to maintain open lines of communication with your instructors, whether in the classroom, via email, phone, social media, or our Learning Management System (Moodle). We also recommend regular visits to our Learning Support Centers, where you can seek help from your peers to overcome any difficulties you may face in your academic journey.

While RHU is dedicated to helping students achieve academic success, students must manage their time effectively and utilize available resources. Students can avoid the potential complications and consequences outlined below by taking responsibility for their academic responsibilities.

Academic Probation

Students receive academic probation if their CGPA falls below 70 after attempting at least 24 credits by the second or any subsequent matriculated semester, excluding summer sessions. Students with two consecutive probations may choose to:

a) Continue in the same major with the approval of the College Council, but risk academic critical standing if, by the end of the following semester, the student accumulates three consecutive probations.
b) Change major: If accepted into the new major, the transferred courses and CGPA will be determined according to the latest major's requirements. If the CGPA for the

transferred courses is 70 or higher, the probation status is removed; otherwise, it remains in effect.

The Registrar's Office shall generate a report of students on probation at the end of every semester and send it to the colleges, which will inform the students and the relevant department of their probation status.

A student may remove probation in a summer semester, but the results of that semester shall not result in probation.

Course Load. Usually, the maximum study load for a student on probation is 12 credits (6 in a summer semester). The load may be increased to 13 credits (7 in a summer semester) if one of the courses is a 4-credit course or a 1-credit required lab course. The load may also be increased to 15 credit hours (9 in a summer semester) if the student is expected to graduate at the end of the semester, subject to the approval of the concerned dean. A student on probation shall be denied access to online registration and must register through the academic advisor. A student on probation must repeat at least two previously taken courses with a grade of 70 or lower and must repeat failed courses when first offered. A student continuing probation must repeat at least three previously taken courses with a grade of 70 or lower and must repeat failed courses when first offered.

Critical Academic Standing

A student shall be placed in *Critical Academic Standing* if s/he:

- Accrues three consecutive probations or four probations throughout the entire period of study, or
- Attains a CGPA less than 60 more than once as a matriculated student.

A student placed on *Critical Academic Standing* by the end of a regular semester must register for up to 15 credits of repeated courses. These courses must be previously taken courses with a grade of 70 or lower, or failed courses.

Based on the student's performance at the end of the semester, the student shall:

1. Resume studying in Good Standing if s/he attains a CGPA of 70 or higher;
2. Continue at RHU on CAS if s/he attains a semester GPA of 75 or above;
3. Dismissed from RHU. The college shall inform the student and the concerned parties of the dismissal decision.

A student of critical academic standing shall be denied access to online registration and must register through the academic advisor.

Forced Change of Major

A student whose CGPA falls below 60 at the end of any semester after the first semester (at least 12 credits) as a matriculated student must transfer to another program and shall not be allowed to return to the old program.

Academic Conduct

RHU embraces the values of academic honesty and integrity and expects all to uphold strict ethical and professional standards. The University forbids any unauthorized use of others' work. Acts of plagiarism, cheating on exams, or other types of work submitted for assessment as part of a course grade shall be subject to possible disciplinary action. Please refer to the Conduct Policy section in this catalog.

RHU Student Taking Courses Elsewhere

Students formally enrolled at RHU may take up to 15 credit hours of courses at a recognized university within Lebanon accredited by the MoHE or at a university outside Lebanon accredited by the country's higher education authority, subject to the following conditions:

- The student is registered at RHU
- The student has completed at least 30 credit hours at RHU
- The courses to be taken elsewhere are equivalent to courses required by the student's major
- The student receives prior approval of the courses to be taken from the student's department chairperson and college dean
- A course is transferred to RHU credit if the grade attained is equivalent to 75 or better. The transfer credits do not count when calculating the CGPA.
- The student must submit certified transcripts to receive credits for transferred courses.

Usually, students are not allowed to take courses elsewhere during the last two semesters before graduation. However, a student may be allowed to take up to 7 credits in the previous semester of studies if the courses are not offered at RHU. Students cannot transfer credits for courses taken elsewhere while on a leave of absence or during formal or informal withdrawal periods.

Student Records and Transcripts

The University is committed to protecting the rights of its students and the privacy and confidentiality of their personal and academic records kept at the Registrar's Office. Only authorized personnel are entitled to access secured Students' records. Professors must post exam results using student ID numbers, not student names. Faculty advisors and academic administrators may access students' records to advise or make academic decisions. Official transcripts may be issued to a third party only if a signed authorization from the student is presented or in compliance with a judicial order. The Registrar signs official transcripts. Students may request an unofficial copy of the transcript or a record of their grades after two weeks of grade posting and at any time they need it. Students can access their records and see their grades anytime through CampusVue.

Student Petitions

If students need to submit a petition, it must be initiated with the help of their advisor. The appropriate form must be typed and completed using proper language. The advisor must verify the accuracy of the information before signing the petition and forwarding it to the department chairperson for approval. A student's transcript should be attached to the petition if the decision is hinged on the student's record.

Commencement Exercises

Commencement exercises are held after the conclusion of the spring semester. Students who complete graduation requirements in the summer or the previous fall may attend the commencement exercises.

After the commencement date, graduates who opt not to participate in the graduation ceremony may receive their diplomas at the Registrar's Office.

Graduate Names on Diplomas and Degrees

Names on diplomas and degrees are spelled exactly as they appear on passports, as required by the Ministry of Education and Higher Education (MoEHE). If, after admission, the name on the passport changes, the student must update the records by submitting certified evidence of the change to the Registrar's Office before graduation; otherwise, the old name will appear on the diploma and cannot be changed thereafter.